Guillem Gonzalez-Lomas, M.D.

NYU Langone Health Department of Orthopedic Surgery Division of Sports Medicine

Informational Packet for Elbow Surgery

Important Contact Information:

- **Surgical Scheduling**
  - Scheduler: Anetam Kaur
    - Please call Anetam with any questions pertaining to surgical insurance coverage, disability forms and/or URGENT pre, intra or post-operative questions or concerns.
  - Phone: 646-460-8723
  - Fax: 646-754-9505
  - Email: Anetam.Kaur@nyulangone.org
- **Office at NYU Langone Orthopedic Center**
  - Medical Secretary: Lorenzo Hayes
  - Phone: 646-501-7223
  - Fax: 646-754-9505
- **For Non-Urgent Requests/ Concerns:** Please send us a message via MyChart. Kindly allow up to 1-3 business days for a reply from a member of our team.
- **After Hours/ Weekends/ Holidays:** On-call direct line will be available in discharge instructions packet given after surgery. You may also call office numbers above and will be automatically transferred to the on-call line.
- **NYU Langone Orthopedic Hospital Samuel's Immediate Care**: 301 E 17th Street, Orthopedic Urgent Care. Open 8:00 AM-10:00 PM, Every day.

Welcome

This packet will segway you through the surgical process here at NYU. We will discuss pertinent pre-operative instructions to make you feel prepared for your upcoming surgery, discuss frequently asked questions regarding your procedure, as well as review important instructions to follow while recovering from home. If you have not already done so, please register for MyChart to access your online medical record. This is an exceptional tool to get information about your upcoming surgery, view your appointments, and communicate with us, your care team, via the message center for a seamless experience. Once registered, you may download the MyChart app to your smartphone or tablet for easy accessibility.

Surgical Intervention

Dr. Lomas will have explained to you ahead of surgery what your diagnosis is and the proposed plan for surgical management. If you would like to see a general educational video for further review, please visit our website at lomasortho.com, click "patient information" and then "patient education," to view our video library. Please note that these are mere animations to illustrate anatomy and are not exact representations of your injury and surgical plan.

Dr. Lomas operates on **Tuesdays** and **Fridays**. Your procedure may be scheduled at one of our three different surgical sites:

- NYU Langone Orthopedic Hospital: 301 E 17th Street
- NYU Outpatient Surgical Center Essex Crossing: 171 Delancey Street
- NYU Outpatient Surgical Center 38th Street: 339 East 38th Street

Pre-Operative Instructions

- You will be scheduled for a pre-operative tele-visit via MyChart with Dr. Lomas' Physician Assistant, Anastasia, three business days prior to your surgical date to review pre- and post-operative expectations as well as to answer any questions or concerns you have regarding your upcoming procedure. This will be scheduled with our surgical coordinator at the time of scheduling the surgery. Please note they are typically performed on Tuesday and Friday mornings and may be subject to change pending scheduling.
- Anetam will notify you if you are required to get **medical clearance**. She will ask you a medical questionnaire while scheduling, to determine the need for further work-up. Please note that you will not be able to proceed with surgery if this is not completed. Kindly be as clear and thorough as possible. We will work with your primary care provider's office as well as any other subspecialty to ensure that we receive appropriate labs and documentation for clearance.
- You will receive a phone call from a nurse from our surgical team **24 hours prior to your surgery** to let you know what time they would like you to arrive. Kindly note that surgical arrival times are not available prior to this. Our nurses will also review pertinent surgical site

information as well as important instructions to follow to ensure smooth arrival. Please find a checklist below:

- No eating or drinking anything after midnight the night before your surgery. This includes gum, mints, hard candy, coffee, protein shakes, smoothies, dairy, soda, juice, alcohol, and/or tobacco. If instructed by our nursing staff, you may have a small sip of water up to two hours before your check-in time to take your daily medications that they have approved and outlined for you.
    - If you are taking any **GLP-1 medications** for diabetes or weight loss (such as Wegovy, Zepbound, Ozempic, Mounjaro, Rybelsus, etc.,), these need to be stopped **at least 8 days ahead of surgery**. You must also **fast 12 hours** prior to your scheduled check-in time. This is because these medications work by delaying gastric emptying and may cause a risk of aspiration under anesthesia. Therefore, it can be a cause of cancellation if guidelines are not followed! Please let our team know if you are taking one of these medications and the date of your last dose.
- Discontinue all vitamins and herbal supplements for 5 days leading to surgery except supplements listed below in the "**Nutrition/ Vitamin Supplementation**," section.
- Discontinue all anti-inflammatories (NSAIDs), aspirin and/or blood thinners at least 5 days before your surgery unless specifically instructed by your primary care provider or cardiologist. Please follow their instructions pertaining to withholding or continuing these medications and notify our office. You may use Tylenol as needed for pain until the day before surgery.
- Wear loose fitting clothing and supportive shoes. Preferably something that buttons/zippers in the front instead of a pullover as you may be placed in a splint and a sling. A splint is a semi-rigid device that immobilizes/ stabilizes the area to promote healing.
- You may practice normal hygiene, the morning of your surgery. You do not need to use a medical grade soap to shower. You may brush your teeth, but please swish and spit. Do not shave surgical site or any part of your body for 3 days leading to surgery. No lotion, makeup, deodorant, or perfumes on the day of surgery. Please remove nail polish/ artificial nails if possible.
- Please removal ALL jewelry.
- Do not bring any valuables with you.
- If you wear contact lenses, please do not do so on the day of surgery. You may wear your glasses instead.
- If you have any dentures or bridges, they will need to be removed prior to surgery. Please bring your own container for proper storage.
- Bring your driver's license/ form of identification, insurance card and all the information for whoever will be escorting you home after your procedure. Please note that this person does not have to be with you from the very beginning but MUST be in the building to take you home.
- Bring a list of current medications and allergies with you for proper documentation.

- If you need any FMLA or disability forms completed, please fax them to Anetam or send the forms via Mychart as a PDF attachment (Please do not take pictures of the forms, please scan the forms & save them as a PDF). Only FMLA forms can be completed prior to surgery. Disability forms are completed AFTER surgery. The turnaround time for all forms is 5-7 business days. If you need them sooner, please let us know and we will do our best to expedite them.

Post-operative Medications

- Post-operative medications will be sent 1-2 days prior to your scheduled surgery.
    - Please give Anetam your updated pharmacy prior to this and let us know if you have any allergies to medication.
- You will receive a MyChart message once sent that will review what the medications are, why you are taking them, when to take them, and certain side effects to look out for.
- Below please find a list of the common post-operative medications we prescribe.
    - **Aspirin:** This medication is used as a prophylactic measure to decrease the incidence of a blood clot (unlikely). We prescribe this regimen in all our patients having surgery.
    - **Diclofenac:** This medication is an anti-inflammatory that is used to help decrease post-operative pain and inflammation. Therefore, please do not take any additional over-the-counter anti-inflammatories such as Advil, Motrin, Ibuprofen, Aleve, Naproxen, etc.
    - **Cephalexin:** This medication is an antibiotic. It is used to protect the incision from any infection.
    - **Oxycodone- Acetaminophen:** It is also known as Percocet. This medication is an opioid used primarily for pain management. It is formulated with Tylenol so please do not take any additional Tylenol or any other medication that has acetaminophen/ Tylenol in it. Again, this is for after surgery and ONLY as needed.
- You will start ALL medications the day AFTER your surgery. Please do not take any BEFORE.
- If you experience constipation, you may take over the counter stool softeners, such as Ducolax, or a gentle laxative, such as Miralax, to help. Kindly notify us right away if this occurs.

Surgery Day

- This is an outpatient procedure, meaning you enter and leave the hospital on the same day. Typically, you will arrive 2 hours before your scheduled arrive time and leave 1 to 2 hours after surgery is complete to allow for ample recovery. Surgical times vary based on the typical procedure; it can range from 30 min to 2 hours.
- When you check in for your procedure, please make sure you have your driver's license/ form of identification, insurance card and all the information for whoever will be escorting you home after your procedure, as mentioned above.
- You will be greeted by Dr. Lomas before your procedure, who will review the surgical plan with you and open it up to you if you have any last-minute questions or concerns prior to the start of your procedure.

- You will also be greeted by the anesthesiologist, who discusses the type of anesthesia used for your case.
    - Usually, patients receive sedation or light general anesthesia. You will be sleeping but breathing on your own with support without full intubation.
    - Also, patients receive a regional nerve block. This is an injection that anesthetizes the whole operative extremity. The effects last anywhere between 24 to 72 hours. Your arm will feel numb, tingly, and then return to normal, which is when you may start feeling pain.
- Once surgery is complete, you will wake up in recovery. Discharge instructions will be given, and our nurses will review specific instructions and guidelines for you to follow.

Post-Operative Instructions and Frequently Asked Questions

- Take all medications as prescribed. As a reminder, please take medication with food to reduce the risk of nausea and stomach upset. Kindly defer to the MyChart message with your post-operative medications for further instructions.
- You may be placed in a splint post-operatively. This will remain until your first post-operative appointment. DO NOT REMOVE. You will also be given a sling for support. You may remove the sling while showering and getting dressed.
- You may shower, NOT BATHE, on post-operative day 2.
    - For Elbow Arthroscopy:
        - At this time, you may remove your sling and surgical dressing. You may wash the surgical site with soap and water. Do not scrub. Please pat dry incisions after showering and apply band aids daily. Make sure that the incisions remain clean and dry. Do not use water-proof band aids.
    - For Open Procedures (Distal biceps repair, Epicondylectomy, UCL repair, Ulnar Nerve Transposition, etc.)
        - At this time, you may remove your sling. The splint will remain. DO NOT REMOVE. Please make sure that the splint remains clean and dry. You may use a plastic bag to cover the operative extremity.
- You can ice the elbow for 10- 15 minutes over the bandage (not on skin) and then 10-15 minutes off. Ice at least 3-4x/day. Kindly note that if you are in a splint the ice will not penetrate the bandage.
- While you are home recovering, if you develop fevers >101, chills, excessive drainage that is saturating the dressing, swelling, redness, worsening pain at the surgical site that does not improve over time with rest, icing or pain medication or the operative extremity becomes cold, blue, tingly or numb or significant GI symptoms (nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, constipation > 72 hours (despite stool softener and laxative use), stomach pain) that is not controlled please contact Dr. Lomas' office right away.
- No driving until cleared by Dr. Lomas. This time frame can range depending on surgery performed (2-6 weeks).

Physical Therapy and Post-Operative Appointment

- **First post-operative appointment** should be scheduled 10-14 days after surgery. During this visit, we will remove your splint, if applicable, as well as sutures and place steri-strips over your incisions for further healing. Additionally, physical therapy will be prescribed and protocol given. You will be cleared to start outpatient physical therapy at that time.
    - **If we are advancing your motion in the initial post-operative period, we will provide you with your physical therapy and protocol before or at the time of surgery.**
    - All of Dr. Lomas' post-operative protocols are available on his website at lomasortho.com, please click "patient information" and then click "physical therapy post-operative protocols."

Exercises

- We do not recommend any home exercises for procedures involving a splint as you are immobilized. Once the splint is removed at your first post-operative appointment, you will be transitioned into a hinged elbow brace and start PT.
- If an elbow arthroscopy is performed, we will provide you with a home exercises program tailored to you at the time of discharge.

Nutrition/ Vitamin Supplementation

- For pre and/or post-operative nutritional optimization, Dr. Lomas recommends the following options:
    - Diet: Lean protein (chicken, fish, lean meat or legumes if vegan/ vegetarian), leafy greens (spinach, kale) and avoidance of sugar heavy drinks or processed foods.
    - Supplements (can choose **one** from the following):
        - XR Xcelerated Recovery Surgical Program
            - **xrscience.org**
            - Patient 20% discount code: **GLMDNYU20**
            - Surgical program includes 1 week prior to and 2 weeks postop
        - Klean Athlete (Amazon. com)
            - HMB + Amino acids
            - Collagen supplement + C (berry)
    - Vitamin D 2000IU daily: 1 week prior to surgery, 6 weeks postop
    - Vitamin C 1000mg daily: 1 week prior to surgery, 6 weeks postop

Smoking Cessation

- Strongly recommended.
- Please reach out for guidance if interested.